

Nitish Kumar Panda

Narrative & Gameplay Designer — Cinematics & Lighting Artist

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SUMMARY

Game designer working across **narrative structure, gameplay design, and cinematics/lighting** in Unreal Engine 5. Experience designing co-op puzzle logic, stealth gameplay systems, and mechanic-driven pacing, alongside authoring cinematic trailers and lighting direction. Also ships mobile titles independently under BrainKraft.

SKILLS

ENGINE	Unreal Engine, Unity
NARRATIVE	Story systems, beat structure, environmental storytelling
GAMEPLAY	Puzzle & mechanic design, encounter pacing, player flow
CINEMATICS	Shot framing, trailer editing (DaVinci Resolve), lighting direction, Sequencer camera work (foundational, learning fast)
DESIGN DOCS	GDDs, story documentation, critique iteration
MOBILE DEV	Unity, Android, Play Store pipeline

EXPERIENCE

Underdogs Studio · Cinematics & Gameplay Designer (Remote) Dec 2025 - May 2026

- Designed co-op puzzle logic and interaction rules that force two players to communicate and coordinate to progress
- Balanced puzzle difficulty and pacing across the shared playthrough for equal engagement on both sides
- Directed reveal and payoff moments so both players experience a solved puzzle's payoff together

Akiyam · Gameplay & Narrative Designer — Assassin: The First List Feb 2023 - Jan 2024

- Designed stealth gameplay systems — detection rules, cover mechanics, encounter pacing — across 4 full missions
- Used mechanic-driven tension to reinforce the narrative weight of each mission
- Game shipped on Steam

SELECTED PROJECTS

The Dyeing World Gameplay + Cinematics 3D platformer — color-coded navigation design; shot and edited the cinematic trailer solo in DaVinci Resolve.

3D Hustle Game Design Sole game designer — authored complete GDD, designed the core economy loop.

Zombie Survival Level Gameplay + Narrative WWZ-inspired underground facility — environmental storytelling communicating danger without UI.

Mirror Mind / Letter Panic BrainKraft Independently designed and shipped mobile titles on Google Play, concept to release.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

Master of Computer Applications (MCA) 2022 - 2024
KIIT University, Bhubaneswar

Game Design Certification 2024 - 2025
Gamer2Maker